

Post-incident review PIR-2025-032

Notification Service: degraded latency

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 08 August 2025, Notification Service experienced degraded latency in production (AU Southeast) for about 160 minutes. Staff in the contact centre noticed the console was slow and told the service owner. Investigation found that the token signing certificate reached its end date.

Impact

Users of Notification Service saw degraded latency for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Messaging, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:15 First signal received.
- 09:35 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:48 Likely cause identified.
- 10:23 Mitigation applied.
- 10:35 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the token signing certificate reached its end date.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.